

phases of business is a rare bird these days. The average young executive has a thorough theoretical knowledge of one single facet of business but knows little or nothing about what goes on in any office or department save his own. He is like the mythical medical specialist who is so specialized that he only examines left nostrils.

If the trend continues, the real businessman—the man who can actually coordinate and run a business because he knows what makes it tick and how it operates—will disappear from the scene entirely. His place will no doubt be taken by some sort of super cybernetic machine. The machine will establish policy, make final decisions and give orders after bits and pieces of information encoded on punched tapes are fed into it by ultra specialized company executives.

To succeed in a business, to reach the top, an individual must know all it is possible to know about that business.

He must be acquainted with the duties and responsibilities of each and every section, office and department of the firm.

He must know something—the more the better—about accounting as well as production, about sales as well as purchasing. Like the old time wildcatters, he should know a dozen— or a hundred—different jobs well enough so that he can exercise direct supervision, increase efficiency and product quality, reduce costs and still make a profit and continue to expand.

Any executive can do a much better job if he peels off his business suit once in a while, climbs into a set of overalls and gets his hands dirty down in the plant. The vice-president in charge of purchasing who has fed the raw materials he buys into a processing vat or a molding oven can do a much better job of purchasing. He can often learn more by listening to the conversation of a few production workers

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for an hour than he can by reading 10,000 specification sheets. Advertising and sales managers who have operated a lathe or punch press and have